

MAX MATTHEWS

Entrepreneurial senior full-stack JavaScript developer and technical leader with **10+ years** of experience building, scaling, and shipping applications across startups, enterprise, and government by leveraging modern tools and **AI** technologies. Skilled at rapidly delivering **MVPs**, validating product-market fit, and guiding projects from prototype to production while wearing multiple hats. Experienced in hiring and mentoring teams with a focus on culture, productivity, and impact. Thrives in lean, fast-moving environments while promoting communication.

Open to **full-time**, **part-time**, or **1099 contract** roles, with flexibility for **remote** work or **relocation**.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

tuzag, inc.

CTO *February 2021 - Present*

- Defined and executed technical strategy for startup and enterprise clients, delivering scalable full stack JavaScript applications.
- Integrated third-party LLMs (OpenAI, Gemini) to build an AI-powered bot for dynamic content generation; leveraged a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) knowledge base with grounding metadata to ensure context-aware and accurate responses.
- Balanced hands-on coding with leadership—project management, hiring, mentorship, and technical oversight. Built and scaled software teams (senior + junior devs) from zero, establishing culture and career growth paths.
- Led mobile development and architected an integrated remote patient monitoring system for the Veterans Administration (Life365 subcontract).

Lead Developer *July 2016 - February 2021*

- Designed and developed scalable multi-channel conversational AI applications (Node.js, React, React Native, MySQL, Google Cloud Platform).
- Built data-driven personalization systems that turned large datasets into actionable, automated communication flows.
- Translated business requirements into agile technical roadmaps, aligning stakeholders and engineering teams.

Rapid Prototyping Specialist *July 2015 - July 2016*

- Built proof-of-concept web and mobile applications to test product-market fit and accelerate go-to-market timelines.
- Delivered iterative prototypes that evolved into production-ready deployments, validating ideas with real users.

Hack Upstate - Careers in Code

Dean of Students & Lead Instructor *February 2022 - October 2024*

- Led software education program operations, including nightly live classes, 1:1 mentoring, and alumni network building.
- Modernized the full-stack curriculum & LMS by incorporating practical applications of AI tools and APIs, preparing students for emerging industry trends and learning new technologies.
- Built student pipelines into tech careers through code reviews, project-based learning, and career mentorship.

Instructor *April 2019 - February 2022*

- Instructing students at a 6 month bootcamp in full stack javascript. Part time roll teaching, curriculum development, & student mentoring.

EDUCATION

Syracuse University, School of Info. Studies *2012 - 2015*

- Completed coursework towards Bachelor of Science Information Management & Technology
- Minor: Information Technology, Design, & Startups

CORE TECHNOLOGIES

- Proficient in: React, Node.js, Meteor, React Native, Javascript, HTML5, Trello, Mongo, Slack, SQL (Postgres), Google Cloud Platform, Webstorm, Git, Bash
- AI: OpenAI API, Gemini API, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), Prompt Engineering
- Previous experience: Government Contracting, Figma, Python, PHP, Wordpress, Docker, Nginx, Jira, Monday